

Diego Llanes

Seattle, WA, USA

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ABOUT ME

I am a Machine Learning Engineer with expertise in building large-scale datasets to develop and deploy computer vision and large language model solutions – I am passionate about making tools people actually use.

EDUCATION

Western Washington University, Bellingham, WA, USA

Master of Science in Computer Science

Sep 2024 - Jun 2025

3.9 GPA

Western Washington University, Bellingham, WA, USA

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

Jan 2021 - Jun 2024

3.6 GPA

EXPERIENCE

Machine Learning Engineer II

Expedia Group

Seattle, WA

October 2025 - Present

- Owned and operated a recommendation service that handled ~2k RPS peak and scaled dynamically.
- Developed “Rare Find” indicators on live site which lead to an increase of 2% uplift in bookings.
- Trained message relevancy models to improve customer likelihood of responding to push notifications.

Contract Collaborator

Allen Institute for Artificial Intelligence (AI2)

Seattle, WA

May 2025 - October 2025

- Created a visual grounding dataset of ~400k screenshots for OCR pretraining of vision language models.
- Filtered dataset to include only successful training samples which improved overall model accuracy by 15%.
- Aided in development of a human data collection tool for collecting real web trajectories of web tasks.

Scientific Machine Learning Masters Intern

Pacific Northwest National Laboratory

Seattle, WA, USA

June 2023 - May 2025

- Added features to an [open-source project](#) which attracted new users from other domains to our project.
- Built automated experiment pipelines for batch deployment using Slurm allowing for rapid result analysis.
- Developed a strong foundation in control theory, deep reinforcement learning and Generative-AI.

PROJECTS / PUBLICATIONS

Web Agents

Allen Institute for Artificial Intelligence (AI2)

Summer 2025

- Developed a vision based multimodal agent to autonomously execute end-to-end complex web tasks.
- Created open source web navigation datasets to accelerate community research of autonomous web agents.
- The manuscript for this work has been submitted to ECCV, the tech report and demos can be found [here](#).

STARS: Sensor-agnostic Transformer Architecture for Remote Sensing

Pacific Northwest National Laboratory

Summer 2024

- Developed a vision model that accepts an arbitrary count of spectral measurements, agnostic to sensor.
- Created a Web GUI front end for the visualization and deployment of experiments for domain experts.
- This work was presented at [IEEE Whispers 2024 conference](#).

BOSS Net: A Self-consistent Data-driven Model for Determining Stellar Parameters

Hutchinson Research Group

Fall 2023

- Built a CNN to estimate the surface gravity and temperature of stars from near-infrared photometry.
- Released a self consistent 412k spectral training corpus by labelling points from a multitude of sensors.
- This work was presented at the 2023 SDSS-V Collaboration Meeting and published in the [Astronomical Journal](#).

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming Languages: Python, Kotlin, SQL, JavaScript, Go, Java, C, HTML + CSS

